



## MONTHLY UPDATE

# Mali: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-10 · 35 systems and instruments tracked, 7 of them not held

*Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-10 – July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.*

## Summary of the month

The window is dominated by two events: the [4th Semaine du Numerique](#), held at the CICB from 28 July to 1 August 2026, which produced a recommendation set covering a national AI strategy, a data-management law, a startups law, a Conseil national du Numerique and a law making SMTD-SA the sole operator of national transport infrastructure; and the [11th board session of the universal access fund on 23 July](#), which cut the 2026 budget by 32%.

Two justice items ran in sequence: a [ministerial instruction to prosecutors on platform content on 29 July](#), and on 3 August a [12-month sentence, six suspended, against a newspaper publication director](#) before the cybercrime pole.

## Infrastructure

On 15 July CSquared [added capacity on the 2Africa West subsea system](#) to the West African backbone whose inland fibre reaches Mali, giving an independent route behind the Abidjan, Accra and Lagos landings.

On 23 July Moov Africa Malitel [announced the retirement of ADSL and migration to FTTH by end-2026](#); no subscriber or coverage figure accompanied it.

On 27 July Maliweb carried a named-analyst investigation into the universal access fund which also [reports AFRIBONE as the sole surviving independent internet provider](#), buying wholesale IP transit at near-retail prices after incumbents allegedly pressed the backbone operator to stop selling dark fibre.

On 30 July the Semaine du Numerique's opening panel [set a universal connectivity target of 2030](#), with the roadmap to be drafted jointly with Burkina Faso and Niger. On 1 August the week's recommendations included [a law making SMTD-SA the sole national operator of transport, transmission, storage and broadcast infrastructure](#).

## Digital public infrastructure

On 8 July the health ministry [launched the national digital health portal](#) under the national digital health plan 2024-2028, flagging power gaps, the urban-rural divide and weak interoperability as obstacles.

On 21 July an editorial account [set out the E-AES passport's specification](#): five categories issued under the confederation dispositif, five years, 34 pages, biometrics on chip, to ICAO specification.

On 24 July the Council of Ministers [adopted a draft ordinance formalising the cahier de recensement](#), the village-level register from which family record books are issued, replacing Loi n06-023 of 28 June 2006. The same session heard the labour ministry report Mali's integrated human resources system to the pan-African public administration forum in Rabat.

On 27 July a ministry field visit [recorded the social security fund's bank-payment pilot for pensions as complete](#) and ready for phased rollout, and documented a Bamako hospital running registration, laboratory, consultation and pharmacy on a single unique patient identifier.

On 29 July the Council of Ministers took note of the first published output of the government monitoring system: [43.43% of planned activities completed in the second half of 2025 — 109 of 251, with 83 in progress and 59 not started](#).

On 30 July the territorial administration ministry [put digital payment at civil registry centres at about FCFA 200 million between July 2024 and May 2026](#) and ordered every collectivite to report within 30 days on why the system is underperforming.

## Governance and regulation

On 15 July, at the UEMOA digital economy salon in Ouagadougou, Mali [spoke for the three AES states and the salon adopted a Declaration de Ouagadougou](#) recommending that member governments place digital at the centre of national strategies.

On 24 July Mali was [re-elected to the African Telecommunications Union board for 2027-2031](#) at the Abuja plenipotentiary.

On 29 July the Garde des Sceaux [instructed all prosecutors, justices of the peace and judicial police to act against networks recruiting through WhatsApp, TikTok and Snapchat](#). The communique enumerates existing penal qualifications and adds that the staging, filming, publication and commentary of such images are themselves offences falling under cybercrime; no new statute was made, no platform was notified, and parents, educators, landlords and hotel keepers are called on to watch and denounce.

On 1 August the Semaine du Numerique's recommendations included [a data-management law, a startups law, a Conseil national du Numerique and a protocol between AES states to harmonise AI governance](#).

On 3 August the [data-protection authority opened its second 2026 session](#) with more than 1,000 files before it over ten days — authorisations, declarations, video-surveillance oversight, formal notices and direct sanction procedures — its president grounding the sanctions in Loi n2013-015 as amended. The same day the cybercrime pole [sentenced Chahana Takiou to 12 months with six suspended](#) on a charge of undermining the credit of the state through the judicial institution, over remarks at a Bamako media forum in June 2026 arguing that journalists should be tried under press-offence law.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

On 1 August the Semaine du Numerique [recommended a national AI strategy](#), which Mali does not have, alongside an AES protocol on AI governance. The [Centre d'intelligence artificielle et de robotique](#) closed the week with a [demonstration of a locally built intrusion-detection technology](#).

## Inclusion, capacity and finance

On 22 July the universal access fund [signed two four-year renewable conventions](#) with the education ministry and the entrepreneurship, employment and vocational training ministry, committing it to connect every secondary, technical and vocational school by end-2027, with more than 80 new universal access centres, 100 new Cases Wi-Fi and cumulative education spend put above FCFA 17bn. The same day an operator [reported 350 young people placed on the labour market](#) from its digital centre.

On 23 July the fund's board [cut the 2026 budget by 32%, from FCFA 41,151,471,000 to FCFA 27,886,688,000](#), recording receipts at 56% of forecast and expenditure of FCFA 3,188,967,162 — 8% of the annual budget in six months. The board attributed the shortfall to the absence of a procedures manual, late budget approval, delayed sign-off on construction studies and insecurity in project areas, and named a new director-general.

On 30 July UNESCO and Japan [handed the education ministry FCFA 88,740,927 of equipment for eight teacher-training institutes](#) — 40 laptops, 16 all-in-one computers, 32 tablets, and projectors, whiteboards, printers and backup devices — with no maintenance, connectivity or software provision stated.

On 1 August recruitment opened for the first cohort of a [digital-skills programme for 15,000 young people](#) run under a convention with the Association Kabakoo.

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